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Top Skills

Artificial Intelligence (AI)
AI Automation
AI Engineer

Certifications

Digital Marketing Certification
Project Management Essentials
Certified (PMEC)
GenAI Academy: White Belt
Prompt Engineering For Business
Scrum Fundamentals Certified

Honors-Awards

Runner up at Financial Planning
School

Justin Underhill

AI Systems Engineer | Agentic AI Developer | AI Automation
Architect

City of Johannesburg, Gauteng, South Africa

Summary

AI Systems Engineer focused on building practical AI solutions that operate inside real business environments. I design and deploy AI-powered systems that move beyond experimentation from agent-driven workflows and LLM-powered tools to automation layers that integrate directly with existing business processes. My work focuses on turning the current wave of AI capability into operational systems that deliver measurable outcomes. Areas I work in include: • Agentic AI systems and multi-agent workflows • LLM-powered applications and intelligent assistants • Retrieval systems and knowledge integration • AI-driven automation and process augmentation • AI architecture for real-world business environments I am particularly interested in AI systems that operate as infrastructure, embedded inside existing workflows rather than standing alone as demonstrations. My approach is shaped by a background in structured project delivery and systems thinking. AI initiatives succeed when they are treated as engineered systems, not experiments. That means designing for: – reliability and operational integration – context management and controlled outputs – human-in-the-loop oversight where appropriate – sustainable cost and deployment models I am currently focused on advancing expertise in agentic AI systems, applied LLM engineering, and production-ready automation, building tools and systems that help organisations leverage AI as a working capability rather than a concept.

Experience

Merchants

Project Manager

April 2023 - Present (3 years)

Gauteng, South Africa

I lead and manage the full project lifecycle, ensuring strategic alignment, budget control, and on-time delivery. I serve as the single point of contact

across internal teams, clients, and third-party vendors, driving collaboration, accountability, and stakeholder satisfaction at every stage.

Key Responsibilities:

Oversee end-to-end project delivery, from initial concept through final implementation, ensuring alignment with business objectives and client expectations.

Apply hybrid project management frameworks to enhance team adaptability and accelerate delivery timelines.

Coordinate cross-functional teams, assigning tasks and managing resources to maintain momentum and efficiency throughout the project lifecycle.

Serve as the central liaison between clients, vendors, and internal departments, ensuring clear communication and timely execution.

Monitor implementation quality, identify and mitigate risks, resolve issues proactively, and manage project documentation—including risks, decisions, and actions.

Ensure all services are delivered within defined scope, timelines, and quality standards, driving high client satisfaction.

Lead structured handovers to operations and application owners, ensuring smooth project closure and knowledge transfer.

Maintain accurate and up-to-date reports, dashboards, and project status documentation to ensure transparency and process compliance.

Bottomline SA

Digital Project Manager

August 2022 - March 2023 (8 months)

Managed end-to-end project oversight, transitioning operations into the digital realm with precise budgeting and scheduling.

Enhanced stakeholder communication, ensuring continuous alignment throughout the project phases.

Conducted market research to keep ahead of industry trends and integrated findings to maintain a competitive edge.

Wetpaint

Reporting & Dashboard Specialist

May 2022 - July 2022 (3 months)

South Africa

Ensured accuracy and thoroughness in project reporting, taking swift actions to address discrepancies.

Developed and delivered training on new systems, facilitating smooth technological transitions.

Kadraa Recruitment

Digital & Tech Consultant

January 2022 - March 2022 (3 months)

London Area, United Kingdom

Led technical workshops and defined candidate requirements for web development positions.

Trained junior team members, enhancing recruitment strategies and candidate selection processes.

NetSum

Independent Digital Consultant

November 2018 - October 2021 (3 years)

Gauteng

Developed and managed digital marketing strategies for clients sourced through the Upwork Freelancing platform.

Implemented effective digital campaign strategies across omni channel platforms based on clients growth requirements.

SearchKings™ Africa

Google Ads Specialist

June 2018 - November 2018 (6 months)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Focused on optimizing Google Ads accounts to maximize efficiency and return on investment (ROI).

Key Responsibilities:

Campaign Management:

Oversaw all aspects of Google Ad campaigns, from conception to execution, ensuring comprehensive management and alignment with business objectives.

Campaign Design and Optimization:

Designed and refined ad campaigns, including paid search landing pages, to meet strategic goals and improve ad performance.

Data Analysis:

Performed detailed analyses of ad campaigns using data-driven insights to enhance effectiveness and ROI.

Online Marketing Integration:

Leveraged Google Ads across various digital marketing initiatives, aligning with broader marketing strategies.

PPC Management:

Analyzed and fine-tuned pay-per-click campaigns to achieve superior ROI, focusing on strategic improvements and cost-efficiency.

Display Campaigns Across Devices:

Managed and optimized display advertising across different devices, customizing approaches for targeted results.

PPC Strategy Development:

Developed and implemented PPC strategies to increase online visibility and strengthen digital presence.

Red September

Digital Project Specialist

May 2018 - May 2018 (1 month)

Centurion, South Africa

Focused on analyzing campaign results to identify patterns and trends that improve the efficiency and usability of company products and services.

Key Responsibilities:

Multichannel Campaign Execution:

Led advertising campaigns across search engines, social media, and mobile platforms, ensuring a unified and targeted marketing approach.

Cross-Departmental Collaboration:

Worked closely with various departments to ensure that advertising efforts aligned with the company's sales and lead generation goals.

Conversion Tracking and Management:

Designed and managed conversion tracking systems, like Google Analytics, to assess campaign impact and guide strategic improvements.

Data Analysis and Reporting:

Conducted thorough analyses of customer data to pinpoint potential leads and optimize future marketing strategies. Prepared detailed reports to track progress and inform decision-making.

Strategic Online Marketing:

Developed strategies with team members to boost website traffic and sales, focusing on a coordinated approach to strengthen the online presence.

BPD Advertising

Social Media Strategist

September 2017 - April 2018 (8 months)

Centurion, Gauteng, South Africa

Objective:

To plan, implement, and oversee the company's social media strategy, enhancing brand awareness, bolstering marketing efforts, and boosting sales.

Key Responsibilities:

Strategy Development and Execution:

Crafted and executed a comprehensive social media strategy, ensuring alignment with the company's goals and objectives.

KPI Management:

Established and monitored key performance indicators to evaluate and guide social media campaign success.

Content Oversight:

Managed the creation of engaging and visually appealing social media content, collaborating with copywriters and designers to optimize information delivery.

Performance Measurement:

Applied robust analytics to assess and report on the effectiveness of social media campaigns, aiding strategic decision-making.

Innovation and Adaptation:

Stayed updated on the latest social media trends and technologies, incorporating new tools and practices to enhance marketing strategies.

SEO and Analytics:

Utilized various social media and SEO tools to improve content visibility and engagement, continuously optimizing strategies based on data insights.

Collaborative Efforts:

Worked closely with the Marketing, Sales, and Product Development teams to ensure a unified approach to corporate goals.

Networking and Influence:

Engaged with industry influencers and professionals to expand brand presence and credibility across social platforms.

Leadership and Team Development:

Directed team recruitment and training initiatives, creating a dynamic and supportive work environment, and enhancing team skills and performance.

Neapolitan Digital

Digital Lead

October 2016 - September 2017 (1 year)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Key Responsibilities:

Data Analysis and Insight Generation:

Analyzed multi-channel data and customer behavior to provide actionable insights and recommendations for digital strategy improvements.

Operational Process Alignment:

Collaborated with Data Analysts to align digital service enhancements with operational needs and customer expectations for seamless integration.

Project Scope and Baseline Management:

Designed project scopes and established baselines to predict impacts on services and guide strategic decisions.

Continuous Improvement Management:

Led the ongoing assessment and refinement of digital customer experiences, ensuring sustained enhancement of service quality.

Channel Strategy Assessment:

Reviewed and optimized digital channel strategies by comparing with emerging technologies and industry best practices.

Innovation Leadership:

Advocated for and implemented innovative ideas within the organization, fostering a culture of continuous improvement and adaptive strategies.

Benchmarking and Competitive Analysis:

Performed benchmarking against industry standards to maintain competitive digital services.

Customer Persona Development:

Crafted and updated customer personas to support personalized and effective omni-channel marketing strategies.

Collaboration with Stakeholders:

Managed relationships with product and content teams, adapting quickly to changes and new requirements.

Customer Engagement Strategies:

Directed proactive communications, enhancing customer interactions and promoting positive behavioral shifts across digital channels.

Straight Twisted

Senior Software Developer

November 2015 - October 2016 (1 year)

Sandton

Role Overview:

Led the development team in executing software projects, ensuring compliance with company standards and timely delivery.

Key Responsibilities:

Technology Leadership:

Stayed abreast of emerging technologies, guiding the development team in adopting new trends to enhance skills and capabilities.

Creative Problem Solving:

Collaborated with team members to ideate and implement innovative solutions, effectively addressing project requirements.

Full-Stack Development Expertise:

Directed both front-end and back-end development, demonstrating proficiency in HTML, JavaScript, PHP, and CSS.

Deadline Management:

Managed project timelines under pressure, maintaining team focus and productivity during tight deadlines.

Stakeholder Collaboration:

Engaged with clients and internal stakeholders, ensuring clear communication and alignment with project goals.

Project Leadership and Task Delegation:

Oversaw project management tasks, delegating responsibilities to optimize team workflow and project outcomes.

Quality Assurance:

Ensured the highest quality of development work, rigorously overseeing all stages of project execution.

Neapolitan Digital

Wordpress Developer

August 2010 - October 2015 (5 years 3 months)

Johannesburg Area, South Africa

Role Overview:

Focused on creating and maintaining visually appealing, highly functional websites tailored to client specifications.

Key Responsibilities:

Full-Stack Development:

Managed all aspects of website development, including both front-end and back-end tasks like theme and plugin implementation, site integration, and security management.

Client Interaction:

Collaborated directly with clients to understand their design and functionality needs, ensuring their vision was accurately translated into the website.

Front-End Design:

Crafted engaging and responsive website designs, prioritizing aesthetic appeal and user experience.

Architecture Development:

Built robust website architectures that supported intuitive navigation and user interaction.

Back-End Management:

Handled server and database integration, ensuring smooth operation and performance of websites.

WordPress Customization:

Created custom WordPress themes and plugins to meet unique client needs and enhance site functionality.

Quality Assurance and Troubleshooting:

Performed detailed website performance testing and resolved issues to maintain an optimal user experience.

Client Education:

Provided training to clients on managing their WordPress sites, empowering them to make updates and modifications.

Ongoing Monitoring:

Monitored live websites to apply necessary updates and optimizations, ensuring sustained site performance and security.

Education

Stellenbosch University/Universiteit Stellenbosch

Certificate in Digital Marketing, Marketing · (2012 - 2012)

Stanford University

CS Online, Computer Science · (2015 - 2015)

Health & Fitness Professionals Association

Diploma in Exercise Science (Personal Training), Exercise
Science · (2010 - 2012)

Umtata High School

High School/Secondary Diplomas and Certificates · (1997 - 1998)

Parktown Boys' High School

· (January 1993 - November 1996)